FOLIO

Product & Engineering Blueprint

A platform for readers, built around being a reader

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PART ONE

Product, Features & Design

Folio is a platform for readers. Not a book database, not a social network about books — a platform built around the full experience of being someone who reads: finding books, acquiring them, reading them, recording them, discussing them, and living a reading life. Goodreads treats books as inventory. Folio treats reading as an identity.

The core proposition: your library is the centre of your reading life, the AI is your guide, and community is what makes it worth turning up for.

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1. Positioning & Brand

The difference: Goodreads is about books. Folio is about being a reader. That distinction gives the product permission to include things that would seem out of place on any existing platform: the tea you drink while reading, the bookshop you want to visit, the chair you read in, the translation you preferred, the afternoon you planned around finishing a novel. All of it coheres because it is all part of one person's relationship with reading.

The tone throughout — in the AI, in the interface copy, in community features — should feel warm, unhurried, and literate. Not a productivity app. Not a fitness tracker for books. Closer to a very good reading companion who happens to know everything about books and quite a lot about you.

Name: Folio. Clean, literary, connotes a page and a collection. Alternative candidates if taken: Stacks, Commonplace, Verso, The Shelf.

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2. Navigation & Layout

Four primary navigation areas, accessible from a persistent bottom bar (mobile) or left sidebar (desktop):

- Chat — the AI reading companion; the entry point for almost everything
- Library — personal collection, all shelves, reading diary
- Browse — discovery, community content, reading paths, bookshops
- Community — forums, book clubs, creator profiles, Reading Life marketplace

The home screen on first open should be the Chat interface with a subtle summary card beneath it: what you are currently reading, your reading streak this week, and one gentle prompt. On mobile, the Library tab is the second most-visited surface and should load instantly.

Public homepage (logged-out): a curated feed of community content — reviews, reading diary entries, library builder essays, BookTok-style video. This communicates what the platform is before someone commits to signing up. Books and reading as a living culture, not a database.

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3. The Library

The personal library is the heart of the product. Every book a user adds exists in a structured record with a rich set of possible states and metadata.

3.1 Shelves

Default shelves (always present, cannot be deleted):

- Reading Now — with progress tracking, start date, session log
- Read — with finish date, rating (optional), reread count
- Want to Read (TBR) — priority-ranked, with notes on who recommended it and why
- Owned But Unread — the guilt pile, separate from TBR
- Wishlist — want to buy, do not yet own
- Not For Me — decided against, with optional reason
- DNF (Did Not Finish) — abandoned, with note on page abandoned and why
- Interested / Watching — on the radar, not committed
- Lent Out — who has the copy and when it was lent
- Reference — books used non-linearly

Custom shelves: unlimited, user-defined. Examples include Favourites, Beach Reads, Book Club, Research, Gifts Received, Dad's Recommendations, Reread Candidates. Custom shelves can be private, friends-only, or public.

3.2 Gift Lists

Gift lists are a distinct shelf type tied to a named contact rather than the user themselves. Each contact in the user's reading circle has a profile: name, taste notes, genres they enjoy, authors they have mentioned, and — critically — books they already own, so the AI never recommends duplicates.

Gift list features:

- AI expansion: describe the person in natural language and the AI builds a ranked recommendation list, explains why each fits, and flags which are available in special or nice editions
- Priority tiers: perfect fit / might like / wildcard
- Occasion tagging: birthday, Christmas, graduation, new baby, etc.
- Claimed markers: shared lists show who has committed to buying which book, preventing duplicates across family members
- Shareable: users can share their own wishlist with a link so others can buy for them
- Budget-aware: AI filters and sorts by price, flags sales, finds secondhand copies
- Nice editions: separate mode for finding Folio Society, Penguin Clothbound, Everyman's Library, signed firsts, or illustrated editions of a specific title

3.3 Birthday & Occasion Reminders

Each contact in the reading circle can have a birthday or recurring occasion date. The platform:

- Sends a configurable reminder (2 to 8 weeks before, user-set)
- Opens a pre-populated suggestion from the contact's gift list filtered by current prices and stock
- Links directly to purchase, or flags for local collection
- In November and December: Christmas mode consolidates all upcoming gift lists into a single gift-planning view with total budget tracking and claimed/unclaimed status across all contacts

3.4 Book Records

Each book in the library carries a rich record:

- Edition and format owned (hardback, paperback, ebook, audiobook, large print)
- Where purchased or acquired
- Condition (for physical copies)
- Price paid
- Cover image (auto-fetched, user-replaceable)
- Tags, moods, themes (AI-suggested, user-editable)
- Private notes
- Public review (linked to profile)
- Reading journal entries (private, per session)
- Linked books (same series, same author, same theme)
- Translation and edition metadata (see section 3.5)

3.5 Editions, Translations & Versions

Translations and editions are first-class objects in the data model, not footnotes. The hierarchy is:

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Work → Translation → Edition → Physical Copy
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A user's relationship can attach at any level: loved the work, disliked the Fagles translation, want to try the Wilson, own the Lattimore, want a Folio Society edition. The AI understands these distinctions and uses them in recommendations.

Translator preferences are stored and used as recommendation inputs: "same translator I read for Anna Karenina" is a valid query. Edition contributors are tracked beyond translator: illustrator, editor, introduction writer, annotator, audiobook narrator.

Translation-aware queries the AI can handle:

- Which translation of Crime and Punishment would suit me?
- I found this translation too archaic — find me something more contemporary
- Which translation preserves the humour best?

- Show me what people on the platform who disliked my translation preferred

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4. Reading Diary & Session Tracking

Reading progress is tracked at the session level, not just the page level. Each reading session is a logged record: book, start page, end page, date, and optionally time. The AI can log sessions from natural language: "Read another 42 pages before bed" — because it knows what the user is currently reading, no title is needed.

4.1 Automatically calculated analytics

- Pages read today / this week / this month / this year
- Average pages per reading day
- Average session size
- Days spent on each book
- Books finished per month and per year
- Current reading streak
- Pages remaining and estimated completion date
- Fastest and slowest reads
- Average time to finish a novel
- Abandoned-book statistics

4.2 Tone

The diary interface should feel like a beautiful record, not a fitness app. No aggressive streak notifications. The system might say "You've read 420 pages this week, mostly in three long weekend sessions." It does not say "YOU BROKE YOUR 137-DAY STREAK." Nudges are gentle and framed as observations, not performance metrics.

4.3 Time-aware recommendations

Once pace is established per genre, the AI can answer: "I've got about 45 minutes — what could I read?" It knows this user reads literary fiction at roughly 28 pages per hour and can recommend something achievable, or suggest a good stopping point in their current read.

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5. The Chat Interface

The AI reading companion is built on Claude and has full access to the user's library, reading diary, private context profile, local bookshops, and external data sources. It is the primary interface for most interactions — not a feature within the app, but the entry point.

5.1 Core capabilities

- Recommend — personalised, aware of what has already been read, never recommends duplicates

- Remind — flags abandoned books, series continuations, preorders for followed authors
- Find — locates books at local libraries, nearby bookshops, online retailers, in digital formats
- Contextualise — author background, publication history, awards, adaptations, historical context
- Compare — translations, editions, an author's earlier vs later work
- Plan — TBR lists for holidays, reading goals, themed reading paths
- Research — draws from Wikipedia, Internet Archive, publisher sites, literary databases
- Track — logs reading sessions from natural language input
- Discuss — talks through themes, characters, structure; spoiler-aware
- Gift — builds and refines gift lists for named contacts, finds editions, tracks prices
- Plan an afternoon — synthesises page count, pace, weather, local shops, TBR into a suggested reading day

5.2 Example queries the system handles

- "I want something like Jonathan Strange but shorter and less dense"
- "I've read all of Le Guin — what's next?"
- "Where can I buy a first edition of this?"
- "Is this available at my local library?"
- "Log 37 pages — I stopped at 214"
- "My mum's birthday is in three weeks. She loves cosy crime and has all the Osman"
- "Find me a beautiful edition of Middlemarch"
- "I'd like to have a really good reading afternoon tomorrow"
- "I've got £50 — help me make a corner of my bedroom into somewhere nice to read"
- "Build me a six-book reading path into Russian literature"
- "Which translation of The Odyssey should I read?"

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6. Private Context Profile

The private context profile is information a user shares with the AI that shapes its behaviour silently and indefinitely. It is entirely separate from the public profile. No other user, no advertiser, and no platform analytics system can access it. The user has complete visibility and control over every item in it.

The design principle: the AI uses this information without referencing it unless the user brings it up first. If someone has recorded a bereavement, the AI simply does not recommend books featuring that kind of loss. It does not say "I know you've been through a difficult time." It just knows.

6.1 Life context

- Bereavement — who, and recency (a loss six weeks ago is different to six months ago)
- Illness — their own or someone close
- Pregnancy, miscarriage, or fertility difficulties
- Relationship breakdown
- Major stress (job loss, financial difficulty, caring responsibilities)
- Recovery (addiction, mental health, trauma)

6.2 Life structure

- Daily schedule and when they typically read
- Realistic uninterrupted reading time
- Whether they have children and roughly what age
- Work pattern (shift worker, 9-to-5, freelance, irregular)
- Commute type and whether they read on it

6.3 Taste and personality

- Whether they use reading to escape or to engage
- Whether they want to be challenged or comforted right now (can be updated)
- Whether they read for emotion, ideas, story, or language
- Their relationship with rereading
- How they feel about difficult or dark content — not a blanket filter, a calibration

6.4 Biography

- Where they grew up and have lived (affects how they read books set in those places)
- Languages they speak (relevant to translation vs original)
- Educational and professional background (affects what needs explaining)
- Family — children's ages for co-reading suggestions, partner's reading habits if shared

6.5 The Diary Layer

An open-ended private diary the user can write in freely. The AI reads entries as context, not instructions. Someone might write: "My dad died last Tuesday. I don't know what I want to read." The AI does not respond to this as a query. It simply knows, and the next recommendation is shaped accordingly — shorter, gentler, less demanding — without explanation.

Time-awareness: a bereavement flag does not mean permanent exclusion of grief from recommendations. The AI softens its avoidance gradually. If the user writes that they feel ready to engage with harder material, the AI responds to that.

6.6 Privacy architecture

- Total user control — every item visible, editable, deletable

- Not used for advertising, analytics, or any commercial purpose
- Local-first option: sensitive context stored on-device, sent to AI at session time only
- Diary entries encrypted at rest; not readable by the platform
- Completely separate from the public-facing social profile

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7. Bookshops & Places

Bookshops are a third major entity in the platform, alongside books and people. The Places layer connects the digital reading life to physical locations.

7.1 Bookshop discovery

- Location-aware search: find independent bookshops near me, secondhand within 20 miles, antiquarian dealers, charity shops with book departments, specialist subject dealers
- Type classification: independent general, chain, secondhand, antiquarian/rare, specialist, academic, children's, comic/graphic novel, charity, market stall, online-only, publisher bookshop
- Bookshop profile pages: shops can claim their own listing, add stock information, post events, feature recommendations from their staff
- Saved shops: users save their home bookshops and favourite shops to visit

7.2 TBR-to-location connection

When a user is near a saved or relevant bookshop, the AI can flag books from their TBR that are likely stocked there. Advanced: shops that integrate stock data can enable exact inventory matching.

7.3 Reading places

Beyond bookshops: users can save cafés, libraries, parks, and other reading spots. The planning AI uses these: "You're in Oxford tomorrow — here are three bookshops worth visiting and a café nearby that works well for reading."

7.4 The GET THIS BOOK panel

On every book page, a unified acquisition panel:

- Borrow: local library availability, request from network
- Buy locally: nearby independent bookshops, chains
- Buy new online: Bookshop.org, publisher direct, Amazon
- Buy used: AbeBooks, Biblio, World of Books, local sellers
- Digital: ebook retailers, Internet Archive, Project Gutenberg
- Listen: Libro.fm (with local bookshop revenue share), Audible, LibriVox

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8. Community Features

8.1 Profiles

- Public reading identity: shelves (user-selected which are visible), reviews, reading stats, favourite quotes
- Reading Year in Review: annual Wrapped-style summary, shareable
- Reading taste fingerprint: genre breakdown, favourite themes, pace, breadth vs depth
- Follow / following system

8.2 Book clubs

- Create or join a club with shared library, reading schedule, and private discussion
- AI facilitates: generates discussion questions, moderates, summarises group consensus
- Public clubs anyone can join, or private invite-only
- Reading Together: a private two-person space for partners, friends, or family to share a reading relationship — see each other's shelves, recommend to each other, read a book simultaneously and share notes

8.3 Reading challenges

- Custom personal challenges ("Read 52 books in 2026") or community challenges
- Genre bingo cards, themed challenges
- Charity read-a-thons with sponsorship tracking

8.4 Forums & discussion

- Per-book discussion boards with spoiler / no-spoiler sections
- Genre communities (crime, SF, literary fiction, etc.)
- Author communities and topic threads
- Translation discussions: per-work threads about which translation to read and why

8.5 Reading paths

A reading path is a curated sequence: an introduction to Ursula Le Guin, a journey through Russian literature, the complete Discworld in publication order, five books to understand the financial crisis. Paths can be AI-generated, community-created, or authored by verified experts. They are shareable, followable, and a primary discovery mechanism for readers entering a genre or author.

8.6 Quotes

- Save and share favourite passages
- Community quote database, searchable by book, author, theme, or mood
- Quote cards: rendered beautifully for sharing to social media

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9. Creator Layer & Public Presence

9.1 Creator types

The community accommodates a full taxonomy of book-related creators, each with different content formats and monetisation models:

- Reader / reviewer
- Bookseller
- Publisher
- Bookbinder
- Collector
- Library builder
- Interior creator (reading spaces)
- Translator
- Academic / critic
- Author

9.2 Blogs

- Every user can have an optional blog (off by default)
- Rich text with image support; book cards from collection can be embedded
- Private reading journal → public review → full essay: a natural progression
- Monetisable: subscription or pay-per-post; platform takes a commission
- RSS feed for followers to read in their preferred reader

9.3 Video

- Native video upload or recording, attached to a book record or shelf
- BookTok / BookTube style; video lives in context on the book's page, not just a feed
- Cross-posting to TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube, Reddit, Bluesky, Mastodon, Threads, X
- Per-platform customisation: different caption, format, and framing; not identical blasts
- Engagement data feeds back: TikTok view counts and highlights appear on the Folio profile

9.4 Shareable assets

- Book cards: cover, rating, short review — one tap to share to Instagram Story or social post
- Reading Wrapped cards: annual summary formatted for sharing
- Shelf aesthetics: digital shelfie rendered as shareable image
- Quote cards: passage rendered with cover art
- Gift list cards: "Here's what I'd love for Christmas" as a shareable visual

9.5 Personalised shops

- Every public user gets an optional shop page: curated recommendations with affiliate purchase links
- Readers who trust a curator's taste buy through their shop; curator earns commission
- "My 10 favourite crime novels" becomes a shoppable, shareable page

9.6 Translator profiles

- Translators can claim verified profiles linked to all their translated works
- Followers receive new translation notifications
- Translators can write about their process, choices, and relationship with the source text
- A community that no platform currently serves

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10. The Reading Life Marketplace

Not merchandise. A marketplace for the objects, spaces, and rituals that make reading life enjoyable. The AI always offers two paths: buy something, or use what you already have. The second option prevents the marketplace from becoming lifestyle consumerism.

10.1 Categories

- Books & collecting: books, beautiful editions, secondhand books, bookplates, book restoration, rebinding
- Reading objects: bookmarks, book stands, reading lights, notebooks, commonplace books
- Atmosphere: candles, tea, coffee, hot chocolate, mugs, blankets, cushions
- Furniture: shelves, reading chairs, lamps, side tables, book carts
- Library building: carpenters, shelving makers, interior designers, bookbinders

10.2 Budget slider

A core UX feature: Make Do → Comfortable → Collector → Dream Library. Adjusts recommendations across all categories. "I've got £50 — help me make a corner of my bedroom into somewhere nice to read" is a valid and well-served query.

10.3 Reading Kits

Curated themed packages: a book, atmospheric items, a short essay, a playlist, a suggested reading order. Examples: Victorian Ghost Story Evening (The Signal-Man, candle, tea, bookmark, essay on Victorian ghost stories), Russian Winter (The Death of Ivan Ilyich, black tea, dark chocolate, pine candle, notebook). Kits can be AI-generated, community-created, or assembled by creators and sold through the marketplace.

10.4 Library Builder as creator

A distinct creator category. Someone builds a beautiful home library and publishes: photos, room dimensions, shelf plans, furniture list, sources, books displayed, total cost, DIY instructions. Other users follow them. This is a content format that belongs here and nowhere else.

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11. External Integrations

11.1 Import (migration)

- Goodreads — critical; must be seamless to drive adoption
- LibraryThing, StoryGraph, Kindle library, Audible listening history

11.2 Purchase & retail

- Bookshop.org (primary ethical recommendation; affiliate revenue shared with indie bookshops)
- Amazon, Waterstones, Blackwell's, Hive, AbeBooks, eBay, World of Books, ThriftBooks
- Libro.fm (audiobooks with indie bookshop revenue sharing)

11.3 Libraries

- WorldCat / OCLC — global catalogue; check holdings at any library worldwide
- UK public library APIs (Axiell, Koha, Symphony — varies by council)
- Internet Archive / Open Library — legally borrowable digital copies
- British Library catalogue

11.4 Data & metadata

- Open Library (Internet Archive book database)
- Google Books (metadata, previews, snippet search)
- Wikidata (structured translator and edition data)
- ISBNdb (barcode and ISBN lookup)

11.5 Discovery & literary

- Wikipedia (author pages, book articles, contextual information)
- Award databases: Booker, Pulitzer, Clarke, Hugo, Nebula, Costa, Women's Prize
- NetGalley and Edelweiss (advance reader copies)
- Literary Hub, The Millions, Kirkus (review aggregation where API accessible)

11.6 Places

- Google Places API (bookshop and location discovery)
- AbeBooks affiliate inventory search (used and rare book availability)

11.7 Social media cross-posting

- TikTok, Instagram, YouTube, Reddit, Bluesky, Mastodon, Threads, X
- OAuth account linking; per-platform caption and format customisation
- Engagement data feed-back to Folio profile analytics

PART TWO

Engineering Architecture

This section covers the technical systems required to deliver the product described in Part One. It is organised by domain: data models, AI systems, external integrations, privacy infrastructure, and the build sequence.

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12. Technology Stack

12.1 Frontend

- Framework: Next.js (React) with TypeScript — SSR for SEO on book and profile pages, CSR for interactive app surfaces
- Styling: Tailwind CSS with a custom design system; typography-led, warm palette
- Mobile: React Native (shared logic layer) for iOS and Android apps; or PWA-first with native wrapper if budget-constrained
- Rich text: TipTap (blog editor, journal entries); Markdown support throughout
- Video: native HTML5 player; FFmpeg for server-side transcoding

12.2 Backend

- API: Next.js API routes or a dedicated Node.js / Express service for heavier processing
- Database: PostgreSQL (primary relational store) — managed via Supabase or DigitalOcean Managed Databases
- Search: Typesense (self-hosted, fast, typo-tolerant) or Algolia for book, author, and community search
- Cache: Redis for session data, rate limiting, and hot query caching
- Queue: BullMQ (Redis-backed) for background jobs: import processing, notification dispatch, AI enrichment, price alerts
- File storage: AWS S3 (eu-west-2) for cover images, user uploads, video
- CDN: Cloudflare — static assets, edge caching, DDoS protection

12.3 AI

- Primary model: Claude via Anthropic API (chat interface, recommendations, session logging, gift suggestions, reading path generation, kit building)
- Embeddings: text-embedding-3-small (OpenAI) or equivalent for semantic similarity in recommendations
- Vector store: pgvector (Postgres extension) for embedding storage and similarity search
- Prompt management: structured system prompts with user context injection at query time

12.4 Infrastructure

- Hosting: Vercel (frontend + API routes) with edge functions for latency-sensitive operations
- CI/CD: GitHub Actions — test on PR, deploy on merge to main
- Monitoring: Sentry (errors), UptimeRobot (availability), PostHog (product analytics, self-hosted)
- Email: Resend or Postmark for transactional email; notification batching via queue

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13. Core Data Model

Three primary entity graphs underpin everything: Books (with their hierarchy), People (users and their relationships), and Places (bookshops, libraries, reading spots).

13.1 Book hierarchy

```
works   id, title, original_language, wikidata_id, openlibrary_id
publication_year, description, genres[], themes[], moods[]  translations   id,
work_id, language, translator_id[], title_in_language  editions   id,
translation_id (or work_id for originals)   publisher_id, publication_year,
isbn_13, isbn_10   format (hardback|paperback|ebook|audiobook|large_print)
cover_url, page_count, illustrator_id, narrator_id   editor_id,
introduction_author_id  series   id, name, work_ids[], position_map
contributors   id, type (author|translator|illustrator|narrator|editor)   name,
bio, wikidata_id, openlibrary_id
```

13.2 User library

```
user_books   id, user_id, edition_id, work_id   shelf (reading_now|read|tbr|
owned_unread|wishlist|          not_for_me|dnf|interested|lent_out|reference)
custom_shelf_ids[], priority, date_added   date_started, date_finished,
date_abandoned   page_abandoned, rating, private_notes   format_owned,
condition, price_paid, purchase_source  reading_sessions   id, user_book_id,
date   page_start, page_end, pages_read   time_start, time_end (optional)
notes (optional)  custom_shelves   id, user_id, name, visibility (private|
friends|public)  gift_contacts   id, user_id, name, birthday, taste_notes
known_owned_isbns[], occasion_dates[]  gift_lists   id, contact_id, edition_id,
priority   claimed_by_user_id, notes
```

13.3 Places

```
places   id, name, type (bookshop|library|cafe|reading_spot)   subtype
(independent|chain|secondhand|antiquarian|            specialist|academic|
charity|etc)   address, lat, lng, google_place_id   claimed (boolean),
claimed_by_user_id   description, opening_hours, website  user_saved_places
user_id, place_id, label (home_bookshop|favourite|want_to_visit)  place_stock
(advanced, opt-in by bookshop)   place_id, isbn_13, in_stock, last_checked
```

13.4 Private context profile

```
user_context_profile   user_id   life_context (encrypted JSON)   life_structure
(encrypted JSON)   taste_profile (encrypted JSON)   biography (encrypted JSON)
stored_locally (boolean)   last_updated  context_diary_entries   id, user_id
content (encrypted at rest)   created_at   -- never readable by platform;
decrypted client-side   -- or at AI inference time via user session key
```

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14. AI Systems

14.1 Context injection architecture

Every AI query assembles a structured context object before calling the API. This is the core of what makes the system work — the AI is never queried cold.

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AI context object (assembled per query):    user.library_summary     -- shelves,
recent reads, current book + page     -- reading pace per genre, average session
length     -- TBR list (top 20 by priority)     -- DNF patterns, abandoned books
user.taste_profile     -- genre weights, theme preferences     -- translator
preferences     -- mood preferences (current vs historical)     -- explicit
dislikes and avoidances    user.private_context  [encrypted, injected at
runtime]     -- life context flags     -- recent diary entries (last 5,
summarised)     -- current reading mode (comfort|challenge|escape)
user.location_context     -- saved bookshops and libraries     -- current
location (if permitted)     -- upcoming travel (if entered)
user.social_context     -- gift contacts and their profiles     -- active book
clubs and current reads     -- Reading Together partners
```

14.2 Recommendation engine

Recommendations use a hybrid approach: semantic similarity via embeddings, collaborative filtering from anonymised community data, and constraint-based filtering from the user's context.

- Step 1: Candidate generation — retrieve semantically similar works via pgvector from books the user has rated highly
- Step 2: Collaborative filter — weight candidates that users with similar taste profiles also read and enjoyed
- Step 3: Constraint filtering — remove already-read, already-owned, on TBR, not-for-me, and context-excluded titles
- Step 4: Claude ranking — the filtered candidate list is passed to Claude with the full context object; Claude re-ranks and writes natural-language explanations
- Step 5: Diversity check — ensure the final set spans authors, nationalities, publication periods, and tones

14.3 Translation recommendation

A specialist sub-system for recommending translations of specific works:

- Retrieves all known translations with their translator's other work
- Pulls community sentiment by translation (translation-specific review threads)
- Applies user's stored translator preferences
- Considers user's stated reading goals (literary fidelity, readability, contemporary voice, humour)
- Can cross-reference what users who disliked a given translation read instead

14.4 Reading session logging (NLP)

Natural language session logging requires reliable entity extraction:

- Current book detection: because the system knows what the user is actively reading, no title is needed in most log queries

- Page extraction: handles "read to page 214", "stopped at 214", "another 42 pages", "finished chapter 12"
- Time extraction: "before bed", "this morning", "21:10 to 22:05"
- Ambiguity resolution: if the user has two active books, the system asks which
- Confirmation: always confirms the logged session before committing

14.5 Planning and scheduling AI

The "reading afternoon" feature and related planning queries require synthesising multiple data sources:

- Reading pace database (per user, per genre)
- Pages remaining in current book
- Weather API (with permission)
- Saved places (bookshops, cafés, libraries)
- TBR list (what comes next, local availability)
- User schedule from private context profile
- Output: a natural language suggested plan, not a rigid itinerary

14.6 Gift recommendation AI

Gift queries inject the contact's profile rather than (or in addition to) the user's own taste:

- Contact taste notes, known owned books, occasion, budget
- Platform community data: what readers with similar profiles to the contact enjoyed
- Edition and price data: nice editions, current prices, secondhand availability
- Deduplication: cross-references all past gift lists for that contact

14.7 Sensory reading kit generation

Kit generation is a creative synthesis task:

- Book metadata: setting, period, mood, themes, nationality
- User inventory (from private context): what they already own that could be incorporated
- Marketplace inventory: available items that fit the theme and the user's budget
- Always generates a "use what you have" version before offering a purchase path

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15. Privacy & Security Architecture

15.1 Data tiers

- Tier 1 — Public: shelves, reviews, reading stats, profile. Standard web security practices.

- Tier 2 — Private (server-side): library data, session logs, gift lists. User-only access, server-side encryption at rest.
- Tier 3 — Sensitive (encrypted): private context profile, diary entries. Encrypted with user-derived key. Platform cannot read in plaintext.

15.2 Encryption for Tier 3

- User diary entries and context profile fields encrypted client-side before transmission using AES-256-GCM
- Encryption key derived from user password + server-side salt via PBKDF2 or Argon2; server never sees the key
- At AI inference time: client decrypts context, constructs the AI payload locally or via a sealed server function that cannot log the plaintext
- Local-first option: Tier 3 data stored only in device secure storage (iOS Keychain, Android Keystore); never sent to the server except as encrypted payload at inference time

15.3 Private context — what it is never used for

- Advertising targeting — hard prohibition, enforced architecturally (it is never accessible to the ad or analytics system)
- Platform analytics or aggregate reporting
- Visible to any other user
- Accessible by platform staff without explicit user consent and legal process

15.4 Authentication

- Auth.js (NextAuth) — email/password, OAuth (Google, Apple)
- Two-factor authentication: TOTP via authenticator app
- HTTP-only cookies, CSRF protection, secure flags
- SSO/SAML available for institutional accounts (libraries, publishers)

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16. Integration Engineering

16.1 Book metadata pipeline

Book metadata is assembled from multiple sources and merged into the canonical data model. Priority order for conflicts: manual platform edits > Open Library > Google Books > Wikidata > publisher-submitted data.

- ISBN lookup: ISBNdb or Open Library API on book add; triggers full metadata fetch
- Barcode scanning: mobile camera → ISBN → metadata fetch (500ms target)
- Wikidata: translator data, edition relationships, award data via SPARQL queries
- Open Library: work/edition/translation hierarchy, cover images
- Google Books: supplementary metadata, preview links

- Enrichment queue: after initial add, background job enriches with full metadata, generates embeddings, tags with AI-suggested themes and moods

16.2 Goodreads import

The most critical import path. Goodreads provides a CSV export. The importer:

- Parses the CSV, maps Goodreads shelves to Folio shelf structure
- Resolves each book to the canonical work via ISBN or title/author matching
- Preserves ratings, dates, review text, and custom shelf assignments
- Runs as a background job; user sees progress and can continue using the platform
- Handles duplicates and ambiguous matches with a review queue
- Target: full import of a 500-book library in under 2 minutes

16.3 Library integration

- WorldCat Z39.50 or WorldCat Search API: availability check at any library by ISBN
- UK library APIs: Axiell Arena, Koha REST API, SirsiDynix Symphony — varies by council; requires partnership agreements
- Availability displayed in the GET THIS BOOK panel with direct hold/reserve links where API supports it
- Internet Archive: Open Library Loans API for legally borrowable digital copies

16.4 Retail & affiliate

- Bookshop.org API: search, pricing, affiliate link generation, indie bookshop attribution
- Amazon Product Advertising API: pricing, availability, affiliate links
- AbeBooks affiliate API: used and rare book search by ISBN
- Libro.fm: audiobook search, indie bookshop association, affiliate links
- Price alert system: background job polls prices for wishlisted books, queues notification when threshold met

16.5 Places & bookshops

- Google Places API (Nearby Search): bookshop, library, and café discovery by location and type
- Claimed bookshop profiles: verified shops get an authenticated API key to post stock updates, events, and staff picks
- Manual curation: editorial team maintains a quality-checked independent bookshop database as a supplement to Places API results

16.6 Social media cross-posting

- TikTok: Content Posting API — OAuth, video upload, caption, hashtags
- Instagram: Graph API — Reels video posting, Stories image posting
- YouTube: Data API v3 — video upload, description, tags, thumbnail

- Reddit: OAuth API — text or link post to selected subreddits
- Bluesky: AT Protocol — post with embedded book card
- Mastodon: Mastodon API — federated posting via user's chosen instance
- Per-platform content adaptation: video transcoding to platform specs (aspect ratio, length, bitrate) via FFmpeg job queue
- Engagement data retrieval: scheduled background job fetches view/like/comment counts for posted content

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17. Build Sequence

Phase 1 — Core (MVP)

Target: a working product that immediately differentiates from Goodreads.

- Hosting, database, auth (Next.js, Postgres, Auth.js on Vercel)
- Core data model: works, editions, translations, user_books, reading_sessions
- Library UI: default shelves, book add (ISBN lookup + barcode), basic search
- Reading diary: session logging, basic analytics (pages/week, streak, ETA)
- Chat interface: Claude integration with library context injection
- Goodreads import
- GET THIS BOOK panel: Bookshop.org + Amazon affiliate links
- Basic public profile

Phase 2 — Discovery & Places

- Translation and edition hierarchy in UI
- Translator preference profiles
- WorldCat library availability in GET THIS BOOK panel
- Bookshop discovery (Google Places integration)
- Price tracking and alerts
- Series detection and reading order
- Reading paths (AI-generated and community-created)

Phase 3 — Community

- Gift lists, gift contacts, birthday reminders
- Public profiles, follows, reading stats
- Reviews, quotes, community quote database
- Book club creation and management
- Reading Together (private two-person spaces)
- Per-book discussion forums
- Reading challenges

Phase 4 — Creator Layer

- Blogs (TipTap editor, public posts, RSS)
- Video upload and per-book video attachment
- Social media cross-posting (TikTok, Instagram, YouTube first)
- Shareable asset generation (book cards, quote cards, Wrapped)
- Personalised shops with affiliate links
- Translator verified profiles

Phase 5 — Marketplace & Platform

- Reading Life marketplace (Reading Objects and Books & Collecting first)
- Sensory reading kit generation
- Budget slider and "use what you have" kit mode
- Library builder creator type and photo essay format
- NetGalley / ARC distribution integration
- Publisher verified accounts
- Monetisation: blog subscriptions, creator commissions, platform fees
- Private context profile encryption (Tier 3)
- Local-first context storage option
- Reading afternoon planning (full synthesis: weather, places, pace, TBR)

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18. Connection to Novelish / Ghost Books

Folio and the Novelish writer platform are complementary products sharing an underlying literary identity. The seam between them:

- Authors on Novelish can claim verified author profiles on Folio
- Publication of a new book flows from Novelish → Folio: announced, available to pre-order, discussed in community
- Ghost Books (the literary imprint) operates as a verified publisher on Folio: manages ARC distribution, maintains community around its titles
- A reader becoming a writer has an onramp: Folio → Novelish
- Shared authentication: one account works across both platforms
- Translator profiles on Folio can link to the production side of translation projects on Novelish

End of document.